RELATIONSHIPS • CREATIVITY • DEVELOPMENT

A person to trust. Space to create. Room to grow.

Comprehensive impact report | Pathways records, 14 January–13 October 2026

Silkfutures creates the conditions for young people to try, reflect and take greater ownership of their lives through trusted mentoring relationships and creative practice in Cardiff.

281
recorded engagements

89
recorded delivery dates

22 / 28
paired identities with higher confidence ratings

The records contain credible examples of increasing creative independence, willingness to accept feedback and renewed participation. They also show setbacks, uneven measurement and ongoing needs. This report makes that distinction visible.

What this report can establish

An analysis of every row in the supplied export, supported by a review of mentoring narratives and the Pathways application’s measurement logic. It is an evidence review of organisational records, not an independent evaluation of causal impact.

281 engagements are participant-linked records, not 281 separate sessions. Confidence comparison uses 28 exact recorded names with ratings on at least two dates. These are mentor observations on locally defined scales, not clinical or independently validated outcomes. [S1–S2]

01 / FINDINGS

Meaningful change, carefully stated

The strongest quantitative signal is confidence

Of 28 recorded identities with confidence ratings on at least two dates, 22 had a higher latest score, three were unchanged and three were lower. Mean scores rose from 3.27 to 4.24. This is encouraging within the recorded group; it is not a success rate for all participants.

The strongest narrative signal is growing agency in creative work

Repeated observations describe young people preparing material between sessions, making their own production choices, completing recordings with less prompting and returning to difficult work. The most convincing journeys show what the young person did differently, alongside the support that remained necessary.

Relationships are the method; improved relationship scores are not universal

Twelve of 26 paired identities had higher relational-connection ratings, six were unchanged and eight were lower. The model can credibly prioritise relationships without claiming that every measured relationship improved. Scores may also change with context, group composition or mentor judgement.

Long-term impact remains a question

The export does not verify sustained improvements in education, employment, mental health or offending after support ends. Creative completion and in-session leadership are observable outcomes. Wider life changes require separate follow-up and appropriate corroboration.

Evidence-led proposition: relationship-led creative mentoring with promising observed developmental outcomes, a clear practice framework and an explicit commitment to strengthen measurement.

02 / REACH AND PARTICIPATION

What the activity data actually counts

Measure	Verified result	Interpretation
Raw export	284 rows / 27 fields	All rows processed; three registration-only records excluded.
Engagement records	281	206 group-linked; 75 individual-linked. Multiple rows can describe one event.
Recorded dates	89	14 January–13 October 2026. Dates are not a count of separate sessions.
Participant labels	73 exact names	Not a verified count of unique people. Case and likely alias inconsistencies remain.
Distinct name–date pairs	270	11 additional records share a name and date; some may be legitimate separate observations.
Repeat participation	35 labels on ≥2 dates	20 on ≥5 dates; six on ≥10 dates. 38 labels appear on one date.
Summed durations	424 hours 10 minutes	Sum across participant records. Not verified delivery or unique participant-contact hours.

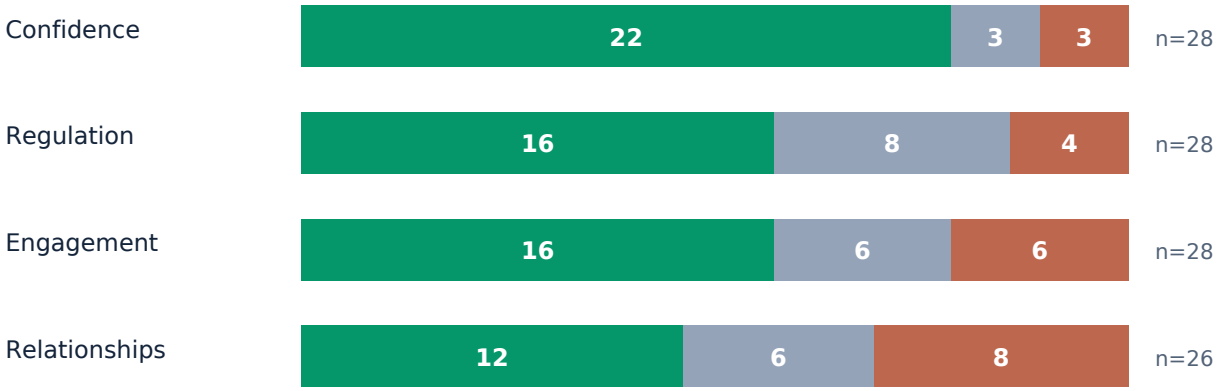
No exact duplicate rows were found, but exact-row deduplication does not resolve duplicated observations, group-level narratives or overlapping sessions. A group session recorded against six young people can appear six times. The export has no stable event ID with which to establish the number of sessions delivered.

Repeat participation is not a retention rate: the export does not contain planned attendance, eligible returners, exits or missed appointments. Case-folding alone changes 73 name labels to 72, and other possible aliases require human resolution. [S1]

03 / DEVELOPMENTAL RATINGS

A positive but uneven pattern

First and last available rated dates per exact recorded identity; same-day ratings averaged.



Green: higher • Grey: unchanged • Rust: lower. Counts of paired recorded identities; earliest versus latest rated date.

Domain	Rated rows / 281	Paired n	Mean first → last
Confidence	198	28	3.27 → 4.24
Regulation	199	28	3.93 → 4.49
Engagement	199	28	4.00 → 4.54
Relational connection	190	26	3.98 → 4.15

The raw average changes are +0.97, +0.56, +0.54 and +0.17 respectively. These summarise ordinal 1–5 ratings; the differences should not be interpreted as precise quantities of psychological change.

The current application uses different wording in different delivery contexts: creative confidence and physical confidence, for example. The exported Regulation field can also contain an emotional-state rating. Pooling therefore describes recorded scores, not one consistently measured trait.

No baseline or endline was imputed. Earliest recorded scores are not necessarily intake baselines, and latest recorded scores are not necessarily exit assessments. Missingness is substantial and is not random. [S1–S2]

04 / LONGITUDINAL ROBUSTNESS

What survives a more cautious reading

Comparison	Confidence higher / paired n	Mean change
All available pairs	22 / 28	+0.97
First and last ratings ≥30 days apart	19 / 21	+1.17
Same mentor at both endpoints	17 / 21	+1.21
Individual-session records only	4 / 7	+0.50

The direction of the confidence signal remains positive under these checks, but each restriction changes the group being compared. They are sensitivity checks, not independent replications. The individual-only sample is very small.

Measurement changed during the reporting period

Month	Engagement rows	Confidence-rated rows
Jan–Feb	53	0
March	44	20
April–June	138	138
July–September	42	40
October to 13th	4	0

Scores are concentrated in the middle of the period. A fall in recorded activity or ratings cannot safely be read as a fall in delivery: completeness, delivery mix and recording practices may have changed. Young people who returned and were rated may differ from those without follow-up.

Group observations are sometimes shared across participants. Ratings can be clustered by event and mentor. No significance tests or causal estimates are reported because the measurement and sampling assumptions would be weak. [S1]

05 / PATHWAYS

A framework for practice, not a ladder of proof

Stage	Observable development to look for
Reset	Returning, accepting support, settling enough to participate.
Reframe	Reflecting on experience, recognising choices, considering a future self.
Rebuild	Practising, responding to feedback and following through.
Release	Making intentional creative choices, completing or sharing work, contributing to peers.
Rise	Taking responsibility, supporting others and creating opportunities.

The current website and application use Reset → Reframe → Rebuild → Release → Rise. These stages describe developmental themes; Discover, Cohort, Pathways 1:1, Alchemy and Rise describe offers. The two systems should be explained separately.

What the export shows

Latest exported profiles: 64 Building Evidence, one Reset, three Reframe, three Rebuild and two Release; none at Rise. All 73 first exported profiles were Building Evidence. Nine therefore acquired an established evidence profile; this is not evidence that only nine people developed or that nine completed a validated progression pathway.

The export reconstructs profiles from evidence available in the current application history. It is not a frozen record of what a mentor assessed on the day. “Stage Confidence” describes confidence in that evidence profile, not a young person’s confidence.

Building Evidence means insufficient documented evidence for the algorithm’s rules; it should never be presented as a young person’s deficit. Session Focus is a planned focus/default, not achieved development. [S1–S2]

06 / OBSERVED OUTCOMES

Beyond the scorecard

Domain	Evidence available	Boundary
Self-awareness	Reflective writing; recognition of self-criticism and changing preferences.	Narrative examples, not a consistent pre/post measure.
Communication	Trying vocal expression, discussing ideas, accepting creative feedback.	Confidence in a studio is not proof of wider communication change.
Relationships	Returning to a mentor; collaboration; encouragement of peers.	Mixed paired ratings; shared notes limit individual attribution.
Agency	Bringing prepared material; initiating tasks; choosing production direction.	Strong in selected journeys; no population prevalence estimate.
Regulation	Staying with a frustrating task; re-engaging with support.	Export mixes regulation and emotional state; no clinical claim.
Achievement	Completed recordings; independently developed work; release submission.	A submission is not a confirmed public release or commercial outcome.
Leadership	Peer encouragement, suggestions and practical help in sessions.	No verified aggregate count of sustained leadership or paid progression.

Marker entries also lean toward early engagement: 83 shows-up entries, 39 reflective-expression entries and 34 trusts-support entries, compared with three supports/leads entries and one creates-opportunity entry. These are recorded marker mentions, not unique people or independent outcomes.

There are 143 engagement rows with Evidence This Session. Qualitative interpretation draws on all narratives, with repeated notes collapsed for reading. No thematic prevalence percentage is claimed. [S1]

07 / INDIVIDUAL JOURNEY

From supported participation to creative ownership

Anonymised journey A • paraphrased from repeated mentor observations

Starting point

Early observations describe a young person needing substantial support to shape and record a song. At later sessions, tiredness and self-critical reactions sometimes interrupted writing. The mentor helped break the work into manageable steps.

What changed

Later records describe material prepared outside the session, greater willingness to hear critique and more independent recording. The young person began bringing creative ideas and prepared lyrics, using the mentor for specific help rather than direction throughout.

The strongest observed moment

> In a later session, the young person reviewed earlier recordings, chose a different creative direction and completed a new piece with greater independence. The evidence is in those choices and actions, rather than a general statement that confidence improved.

What remains uncertain

Self-criticism continued to appear in the record. This is a story of increased creative ownership with ongoing support, not a claim of complete personal transformation. Other activities and relationships may also have contributed. No employment or wider wellbeing outcome is attributed to Silkfutures.

This is a single real longitudinal journey, not a composite. Names, song titles, precise dates, ages, family information and sensitive circumstances have been removed. Source linkage is held only in the restricted evidence register. [S1, case A]

08 / INDIVIDUAL JOURNEYS

Progress includes setbacks

Journey B • finding an independent creative voice

Early sessions involved considerable prompting and uncertainty about vocal expression. Later notes describe independent writing, self-prepared demos and deliberate choices about production. The young person eventually brought their own artwork and participated in preparing work for release submission.

The trajectory was uneven: frustration and disengagement still appeared, and later work returned to material the young person disliked. The defensible outcome is growing ownership of creative decisions and completion of work with support. Public release, income and sustained wellbeing improvement are not verified.

Journey C • changing the approach to reconnect

A young person initially appeared withdrawn and unsure what to do in sessions. The mentor made room for interests beyond music and less pressured conversation. Later observations describe the young person initiating beat-making, taking the lead in an activity and sharing an interest with the mentor.

This shows how responsiveness may help rebuild participation. It does not establish which element caused the change or whether it lasted outside the recorded relationship. Near-identical notes on different dates were not treated as separate corroborating examples.

> A balancing observation: another journey combined expressive progress with continuing difficulty and ongoing support needs. Creative achievement should never be treated as proof that difficulties elsewhere in life have resolved.

All accounts are paraphrases without identifying or safeguarding details. They are selected for explanatory value, not as a representative sample. They do not use unverified participant quotations. [S1, cases B–D]

09 / DELIVERY PATTERNS

Recording practice shapes the visible evidence

Partner label	Rows	Name labels*	Dates*	Confidence rows
SilkFutures	191	64	73	164
Grangetown	38	15	7	0
Grangetown Project	1	1	1	0
Set Pace	37	10	9	34
St Mellons	14	4	5	0

*Counts overlap across labels and cannot be added. Partner labels are not a reliable programme or venue taxonomy.

No confidence ratings were available under the Grangetown, Grangetown Project or St Mellons labels. Their work cannot be evaluated as less effective on that basis. The umbrella SilkFutures label includes different activities; the export does not permit a trustworthy comparison of all named website programmes or physical locations.

Mentor coverage

Five mentors are represented. In anonymised order by record volume, they contributed 134, 104, 22, 15 and six records. Their confidence-rating coverage was 94/134, 76/104, 19/22, 3/15 and 6/6 respectively. Two mentors account for most records.

These figures show where recording and calibration support should concentrate. They do not rank mentor effectiveness: caseloads, session type, contact frequency and narrative detail differ, and some young people see more than one mentor.

Programme effectiveness and location effects remain unanswerable without separate programme IDs, venue IDs, event IDs, stable participant IDs and agreed recording standards. [S1]

10 / METHOD AND LIMITATIONS

How the evidence was reviewed

Scope: the complete supplied CSV, exported 24 October 2026: 284 data rows, 27 fields. Three registration-only rows were excluded from engagement analysis. All other rows were retained, including mixed or adverse observations. No silent alias merging was performed.

Quantitative method: exact trimmed participant names used as provisional identities; ISO dates ordered chronologically; counts calculated across all records. For each rating, multiple scores on one date were averaged, then earliest and latest distinct rated dates compared. Blanks were not treated as zero. Duration categories were converted to minutes and summed only as a diagnostic.

Qualitative method: notes and mentor reflections reviewed across the full export, grouping identical narrative pairs to avoid repeated reading of shared group text. There were 125 distinct note/reflection combinations. Journeys were chosen for repeated behavioural detail, change over time and counter-evidence. No independent second coder was used.

System review: the current Pathways export and development-profile functions were inspected. Marker counts and stage outputs were interpreted in light of evidence thresholds, historical inference and cumulative classification. The CSV does not include the IDs, assessment versions or provenance needed to independently reproduce every stage decision.

Limitations: uncertain identity resolution; duplicated/shared observations; possible misattributed text; incomplete and changing measures; different scale wording across contexts; subjective and potentially AI-assisted interpretation; variable follow-up; no counterfactual; no linked post-exit dataset. The analysis establishes observed patterns, not attribution.

Confidentiality: public narratives exclude names, precise identifying combinations and sensitive safeguarding material. Raw notes, safeguarding fields and the participant mapping are not included. Case accounts remain subject to the organisation’s publication-consent and re-identification check before external release.

File fingerprint: SHA-256 8d07a29707b8bbfedf2d802afba844a6e7be9d8aa0251f912bd5f2aee03a194c. This is a record audit, not an assurance opinion or a certification of the underlying records.

11 / ACCOUNTABILITY

A stronger evidence commitment

Next step	Practical standard
Resolve identities and events	Stable participant ID and event ID; retain separate mentor observations; distinguish event duration, attendance duration and staff hours.
Separate evidence from interpretation	Record the observed action, support required, context and young person's own view. Mark AI suggestions and mentor approval separately.
Use consistent review points	Intake or first settled session, planned midpoint, exit and optional follow-up. Report invited, completed and missing responses.
Calibrate the framework	Review a small shared set of de-identified examples with mentors each month. Record disagreements; do not force linear progression.
Verify destinations	With consent, confirm education, work, volunteering or release outcomes; distinguish offered, started and sustained.
Publish one controlled snapshot	Dated reporting period, definitions, numerator and denominator, limitations and named organisational sign-off.

Sources and interpretation

[S1] Silkfutures Pathways full CSV supplied for this review, export 24 October 2026; record dates 14 January–13 October 2026. Calculations and restricted source-row references retained in the review pack. [S2] Silkfutures Pathways repository: lib/utils.js, lib/constants.js and app/page.js, inspected 24 October 2026 through connected GitHub. Current implementation may differ from that used when older notes were entered. [S3] Silkfutures website and silkfutures-site repository, inspected 24 October 2026. Website base commit e9bc9f8f7d17788c1b29da3830abcd7b7e94dd36. https://www.silkfutures.com/

The case for investment is strongest when Silkfutures shows the relationship, the creative task, the observable change and the remaining uncertainty together.